

Over the Wire Challenge

Bandit

1. Level 1 - Level 5

a. Level 1

- **Level goals** : The password for the next level is stored in a file called `readme` located in the home directory. Use this password to log into `bandit1` using SSH. Whenever you find a password for a level, use SSH (on port 2220) to log into that level and continue the game.
- **Explanation** :

```
bandit1@bandit:~$ ls -la
total 24
-rw-r----- 1 bandit2 bandit1  33 Jun 24 14:59 -
drwxr-xr-x  2 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 150 root    root    4096 Jun 24 15:02 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     220 Feb 13  2026 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    3851 Jun 24 14:50 .bashrc
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     807 Feb 13  2026 .profile
bandit1@bandit:~$
```

Using `cat -` won't solve the level because `-` represents **Standard Input (stdin)**. When executed, the terminal waits for manual text input from the user instead of opening the file. To fix this, we need to specify the relative path by adding `./` before the file name (e.g., `cat ./-`)

As a solution, you can use this command `cat ./-`

```
bandit1@bandit:~$ cat ./-
PK8fYLZg2hnHSz83p1BL1iEPKdD3QToB
bandit1@bandit:~$
```

Password for level 2 : PK8fYLZg2hnHSz83p1BL1iEPKdD3QToB

b. Level 2

- **Level goals** : The password for the next level is stored in a file called `-` located in the home directory
- **Explanation** : The filename contains space and starts with dashes, causing the `cat` to see the filename as a flag or multiple argument.

```
bandit2@bandit:~$ ls -la
total 24
-rw-r----- 1 bandit3 bandit2 33 Jun 24 14:59 --spaces in this filename--
drwxr-xr-x  2 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 150 root    root    4096 Jun 24 15:02 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    220 Feb 13 2026 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root   3851 Jun 24 14:50 .bashrc
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    807 Feb 13 2026 .profile
bandit2@bandit:~$
```

As a solution, you can use this command `cat ./--spaces\ in\ this\ filename--` there is a space. Final command would be “`cat ./--spaces\ in\ this\ filename--`”

```
bandit2@bandit:~$ cat ./--spaces\ in\ this\ filename--
7ZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBl4m3clclL7tGYJPME
```

Password for level 2 : 7ZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBl4m3clclL7tGYJPME

c. Level 3

- **Level goals** : The password for the next level is stored in a hidden file in the inhere directory
- **Explanation** : In this level, the password is stored inside a hidden file. Using the regular `ls` command will not work because it ignores hidden files. To reveal all files including hidden ones we need to use `ls -a`. After locating the hidden file, we can read its content using the `cat` command.

As a solution, you type `ls` to find “inhere” folder. Then, `cd inhere` to set current path into inhere folder. Then, type `ls -a` to find hidden file named “...Hiding-From-You”. After that the only thing you need to do is `cat “...Hiding-From-You”`

```
bandit3@bandit:~$ ls -a
.  ..  .bash_logout  .bashrc  .profile  inhere
bandit3@bandit:~$ cd inhere/
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ ls -a
.  ..  ...Hiding-From-You
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ ls
bandit3@bandit:~/inhere$ cat ...Hiding-From-You
xzTXq1rDJQVVAzdv5cHq1TQytTWufAMq
```

Password for level 3 : xzTXq1rDJQVVAzdv5cHq1TQytTWufAMq

d. Level 4

- **Level goals :** The password for the next level is stored in the only human-readable file in the inhere directory. Tip: if your terminal is messed up, try the “reset” command.
- **Explanation :** In this level, the password is in one of the files that is in the “inhere” folder, the problem is there are 7 files that we need to check, one of them is human readable. Checking them one by one is only a waste of time.

Solution :

1. type `ls -la`, to see all of the file we have in “inhere” folder.

```
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ ls -la
total 48
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file00
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file01
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file02
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file03
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file04
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file05
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file06
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file07
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file08
-rw-r----- 1 bandit5 bandit4 33 Jun 24 14:59 -file09
drwxr-xr-x 2 root      root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 root      root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 ..
```

2. Check metadata of each file, but checking them one by one is going to take so much time. So instead of using files `./-` to checking each file per command, we can use `file ./*` to check all of them in one command.

```
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ file ./*
./-file00: data
./-file01: data
./-file02: data
./-file03: data
./-file04: data
./-file05: data
./-file06: OpenPGP Public Key
./-file07: ASCII text
./-file08: data
./-file09: Motorola S-Record; binary data in text format
```

3. We can see each metadata for the file in “inhere” folder, but how we can know which one is human readable. You can try to use “`cat ./*`”, if you don’t know which one is human readable

```
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ cat ./*
Y1[0b10000 00>0D~1K0
3'000000kbj.j000W000000ylbz0009az000090000rf0VE0fQ0|00o00000
000o00{|000y0M000f00Y00D00x)00zd0TAQ0c0a0u~0\00[000Z]000dS00 Nl0000;(1~500Iv0
L0;M0b{0#00LSv+03G
0'000E'4000φ::0~)00`D
06C7h9GD8M6ai5nr7wo1RonrzFjj9yIrG
F$00000b0L000000
0!0)0LWK0j0S000!ž6000@0?H"093j%A0,08000z0bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$
```

4. Or we know that ASCII text is one of human readable. ASCII text is a character encoding standard. Which means ascii text is the only human readable text in this folder. All we need try is "cat ./-file07".

```
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$ cat ./-file07
6C7h9GD8M6ai5nr7wo1RonrzFjj9yIrG
bandit4@bandit:~/inhere$
```

Password for level 4 : 6C7h9GD8M6ai5nr7wo1RonrzFjj9yIrG